

Bomi K. Lee

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Academic Appointments

Visiting Assistant Professor

Department of Political Science, Bucknell University July 2025 - May 2026

Department of Political Science, University of Arkansas August 2024 - May 2025

National Science Foundation (NSF)-funded Post-doctoral Scholar

Department of Political Science, Washington University in St. Louis August 2022 - May 2024

Department of Political Science, University of Kentucky August 2021 - July 2022

Working with Dr. Tiffany D. Barnes and Dr. Diana Z. O'Brien in their NSF-funded research program on [Women as Leaders, Policy-Makers, and Symbols](#).

Education

Ph.D. Political Science, University of Iowa 2021

Dissertation: *Interconnected Rivalries*

Committee: Sara McLaughlin Mitchell (chair), Kelly M. Kadera, Brian Lai, Elizabeth Menninga, and Paul F. Diehl

MA, Political Science, University of Iowa 2019

MA, International Relations, Seoul National University (South Korea) 2013

BA, Political Science, Seoul National University (South Korea) 2011

Publications

[7] Barnes, Tiffany D., **Bomi K. Lee**, and Diana Z. O'Brien, "Shattered Pathways: Women's Access to Interior Ministries in the Wake of Terrorism." *The Journal of Politics* (Forthcoming). DOI: [10.1086/742110](https://doi.org/10.1086/742110)

[6] Bagwell, T. E., Dee, S. G., Luo, X., Stravato, A., Saikumar, D., Viens, F., **Lee, B. K.**, O'Brien, D., & Mankin, J. S. 2026. "Global and Regional Climate Modes Modulate Armed Conflict Risk." *PNAS* 123(20): e2532935123. DOI: [10.1073/pnas.2532935123](https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2532935123)

[5] **Lee, Bomi K.** 2026. "Multiple Rivals and Leadership Approval: Evidence from Japan." *Foreign Policy Analysis* 22(1): orafo35. DOI: [10.1093/fpa/orafo35](https://doi.org/10.1093/fpa/orafo35)

[4] **Lee, Bomi K.**, and Sojeong Lee. 2025. "Contested Boundaries in Changing Climates: Precipitation Variability and Interstate Diplomatic Conflict." *Environment and Security* 3(4): 555-576. DOI: [10.1177/27538796251333958](https://doi.org/10.1177/27538796251333958)

[3] **Lee, Bomi K.** 2023. "Triangles, Major Powers, and Rivalry Duration." *Journal of Conflict Resolution* 67(6): 1128-1154. DOI: [10.1177/00220027221134781](https://doi.org/10.1177/00220027221134781)

Earlier draft awarded the John Sprague Award (the best paper on political networks presented by a graduate student), issued by the Political Networks Section of APSA (2022)

[2] **Lee, Bomi K.**, Sara McLaughlin Mitchell, Cody J. Schmidt, and Yufan Yang. 2022. "Disasters and the Dynamics of Interstate Rivalry." *Journal of Peace Research* 59(1): 12-27. DOI: [10.1177/00223433211063333](https://doi.org/10.1177/00223433211063333)

[1] Schmidt, Cody J., **Bomi K. Lee**, and Sara McLaughlin Mitchell. 2021. "Climate Bones of Contention: How Climate Variability Influences Territorial, Maritime, and River Interstate Conflicts." *Journal of Peace Research* 58(1): 132-150. DOI: [10.1177/0022343320973738](https://doi.org/10.1177/0022343320973738)

Earlier draft awarded ISA Midwest's Frank J. Klingberg Best Paper Award (2019)

Book Chapter

[1] **Lee, Bomi K.** 2014. "North Korea's Peace Proposals in the 1970s," *Segye Jeongchi [World Politics]* 20: 323-370 [In Korean].

Working Papers

[4] Barnes, Tiffany D., Alexis Jang, **Bomi K. Lee**, and Diana Z. O'Brien, "Can a Woman be Secretary of Defense? Public Perceptions of the Appointment of a Woman Defense Minister."

Using original survey experiments in the United States (about 1,000 respondents) and abroad (South Korea, about 11,000; China, planned), this paper asks whether public opinion constrains women's access to top defense posts. Americans are, on average, no less supportive of women than men appointees—though reactions vary by party and by preferences over the use of force—and South Korean respondents view a woman defense minister as equally competent and trustworthy, suggesting that structural and elite-level factors, rather than mass opinion, most limit women's entry into these positions.

[3] Barnes, Tiffany D., **Bomi K. Lee**, and Diana Z. O'Brien, "Women in Security Portfolios: A New Dataset."

This paper introduces an original dataset of women's appointments to security-related cabinet portfolios—defense, foreign affairs, and interior ministries—at the country-month level, offering considerably finer temporal granularity than existing measures. As one application, we focus on natural disasters and show that they shorten the time women interior ministers remain in office.

[2] **Lee, Bomi K.**, "Triangles, Mixed Alliance-Rivalry Dyads, and Conflict Propensity."

This paper examines how indirect allies shape the obligation of non-aggression between rivals, and how mutual allies influence conflict management between them. It finds that mutual alliance ties affect not only the frequency of militarized disputes between rivals but also the contentiousness of the issue areas at stake.

[1] **Lee, Bomi K.**, Cody J. Schmidt, and Sara McLaughlin Mitchell, "Paths to Peace in Issue Rivalries"

This paper moves beyond the dyadic rivalry context by considering how issue rivalry networks and extra-rivalry reputations influence peaceful and militarized conflict management in diplomatic issue conflicts. We capture interdependence by assessing the degree to which states are embedded in multiple rivalries using network analysis. We find that rivalry networks constrain militarization by target states in issue claims but have no effect on challengers.

Other Publications

[1] Barnes, Tiffany D., **Bomi K. Lee**, and Diana Z. O'Brien, "[Even After Albright, Foreign Policy Leaders Are Still Mostly Men](#)," *The Washington Post, Monkey Cage* (March 28, 2022).

Honors, Awards, and Grants

Travel Grant (\$150), American Political Science Association (2022)

The John Sprague Award (the best paper on political networks presented by a graduate student), "Triangles, Major Powers, and Rivalry Duration," Political Networks Section of APSA (2022)

Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award (\$1,000), University of Iowa (2021)

Graduate College Post-Comprehensive Research Fellowship (\$10,000), Graduate College, University of Iowa (2020)

Graduate College Summer Fellowship (\$5,000), Graduate College, University of Iowa (2020)

Travel Grant (\$150), International Studies Association-Midwest (2020)

Research Grant (\$1,000), Department of Political Science, University of Iowa (2020)

The Frank J. Klingberg Best Paper Award, Cody Schmidt, **Bomi K. Lee**, and Sara McLaughlin Mitchell, "Climate Bones of Contention", International Studies Association Midwest (2019)

Research Grant (\$1,400), Department of Political Science, University of Iowa (2019)

Research Grant (\$500), Graduate & Professional Student Government, University of Iowa (2019)

Travel Grant (\$200), American Political Science Association (2019)

Travel Grant (\$500), Department of Political Science, University of Iowa (2019)

NSF Fellowship (\$900), Political Networks Workshops & Conference (2019)

Travel Funds Award (\$750), Graduate Student Senate (GSS), University of Iowa (2019)

Best Course Paper Award, "Dissolution of Rivalries and Formation of Warm Peace," Department of Political Science, University of Iowa (2018)

Travel Grant (\$550), Department of Political Science, University of Iowa (2018)

Summer Training Grant (\$3,300), Department of Political Science, University of Iowa (2017)

Travel Grant (\$600), Department of Political Science, University of Iowa (2017)

Research and Teaching Interests

International Relations: International Conflict and Cooperation, Interstate Rivalries, Interaction between Domestic and International Politics, Environmental Issues, Regional Security (East Asia)

Political Methodology: Introductory Statistics, Network Analysis, Time Series Analysis, Survival Analysis, Spatial Analysis, Survey Experiments

Research Experiences

University of Iowa

Countries Facing Multiple Rivals Project (online survey experiment in Japan) August 2019 - August 2021

Designed experiment/questionnaire and received the IRB approval (n=1,200).

Research Assistant on Project Haystack (with GoDaddy.com) for Prof. Caroline Tolbert and Prof. Karen Mossberger January 2021 - June 2021; September 2018 - December 2019

Cleaned raw data (n=20 million), visualized collapsed data (at the state/county/ZIP code levels), and conducted empirical analysis.

Research Assistant for Prof. Elizabeth Menninga Summer 2019

Combined civil war datasets (UCDP/PRIO Armed Conflict Dataset, Non-State Actors in Armed Conflict Dataset, etc), and visualized networks and empirical results.

Research Assistant on Issue Correlates of War (ICOW) Project for Prof. Sara McLaughlin Mitchell Summer 2017

Searched news stories for identity claims in Asia via LexisNexis.

The Institute for Far Eastern Studies (South Korea)

Research Intern for Prof. Jong-Dae Shin March 2015 - October 2015

Searched and made a list of released governmental documents on the relationship between South Korea and North Korea.

Seoul National University (South Korea)

Research Assistant on East Asian International Relations Theory Project for Prof. Wookhee Shin September 2012 - August 2015

Teaching Experiences

Bucknell University

International Politics Fall 2025, Spring 2026
Quantitative Methods Fall 2025

University of Arkansas

Introduction to International Relations Spring 2025
Introduction to Comparative Politics Fall 2024, Spring 2025

University of Iowa

Guest Lecturer for Advanced Methodology (Graduate-Level) Fall 2021

Taught the concept of centrality in networks and how to use R to calculate various centrality measures.

Instructor for Analyzing Political Data Spring 2020

(Online) Teaching Assistant for Consequences of War Spring 2021

Teaching Assistant for Introduction to International Relations Fall 2016/2017, Spring 2018
(Online) Teaching Assistant for Introduction to International Relations Summer 2018
Teaching Assistant for Introduction to American Politics Spring 2017

Iowa Social Science Research Center, University of Iowa

Statistical Consultant Fall 2019 - Spring 2021

Taught workshops: Introduction and Data Management Using R, Network Visualization Using R, and Network Analysis Using R

ICPSR Summer Program, University of Michigan

Teaching Assistant for Time Series Analysis 1 Summer 2019

Taught six computer lab sessions with Dr. Desmond Wallace, and graded assignments.

Seoul National University (South Korea)

Teaching Assistant for Introduction to International Relations Fall 2011

Additional Training

ICPSR Summer Program, University of Michigan Summer 2017

Game Theory 1 & Rational Choice Theories of Politics and Society

ISRC Workshops, University of Iowa Fall 2018

Python Basics

Invited Talks and Workshops

Journeys in World Politics, University of Iowa (2022)

Political Networks (PolNet), "Introduction to Network Analysis in R" (2022, 2023, 2024): invited as an instructor

Visions in Methodology (VIM), Claremont Graduate University (2021)

Department of Political Science, Rice University (2021)

University of Alabama's ISSR Workshop on International Conflict (2020): canceled due to COVID-19

Minnesota Political Methodology Graduate Student Colloquium (2019)

Conferences

Paper Presentations

American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (2020, 2022)

American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (co-author) (2019, 2021)

International Studies Association Annual Conference (2021, 2022, 2023)

International Studies Association Annual Conference (co-author) (2022, 2024)

International Studies Association Midwest Annual Conference (2017, 2018, 2019, 2020)

Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (2018, 2026)

Peace Science Society Annual Meeting (co-author) (2019, 2020)

Political Networks (2022)

Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting (2022)

Conference Within A Conference on Rethinking Disaster Politics and Policy

Poster Presentations

International Studies Association Annual Conference (2020): canceled due to COVID-19

Peace Science Society Annual Meeting (2019, 2023)

Political Networks (2019)

Professional Affiliations

American Political Science Association

International Studies Association

Peace Science Society

Disciplinary Service

Referee

American Political Science Review

Asian Security

British Journal of Political Science

Conflict Management and Peace Science

Foreign Policy Analysis

International Interactions

International Studies Quarterly

Journal of Peace Research

Journal of Politics

Political Geography

Review of International Organizations

Award Committees

John Sprague Award issued by the Political Networks Section of APSA, Chair (2024)

John Sprague Award issued by the Political Networks Section of APSA (2023)

Section Service

Program Committee, Political Networks, Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting (2025, 2026)

Communications Director, Political Networks Section of APSA (2023-2025)

Departmental Service

Scholarships Committee, Department of Political Science, University of Arkansas (2025)

Instructor, Math Camp for incoming graduate students, Department of Political Science, University of Iowa (2019, 2020)